

CARRIER STRIKE FIGHTER JET

Deck crew direct an F/A-18 Hornet strike fighter and ground attack aircraft as it prepares to launch from the US supercarrier *Kitty Hawk* during its operations in the Persian Gulf. Around 85 aircraft are deployed on the carrier, which ranks among the largest warships ever built, with a crew of over 5,000 men. The F/A-18 has been the mainstay of American naval aviation since the 1980s.